

THE DOLEFUL

First Baseman's Long Stretch to Be a Big Help

By LESTER KOELLING

HOLLYWOOD, FLA.—The tape measure was brought out for a different purpose than measuring Mickey Mantle home runs, and it revealed that Ron Jackson has a reach of 7 feet, 6 inches from glove to bag at first base.

Those 90 inches will be a tremendous help in completing double plays and they also make for an easy target for Indianapolis infielders. As one of them remarked: "You've got 100 square feet to throw at with Ron over there, and that makes a big difference when making those hurried plays."

Jackson played only his second game in the last 15 days yesterday when the Indians nosed out their "B team"—Colorado Springs—1-0 on Dom Dituso's home run inside the park. The giant first-sacker came up with one great play, but he failed to hit safely although connecting solidly on two occasions.

For all of his hulk—240 pounds on a 6.7 frame—Ron is easygoing, soft-spoken and almost timid. He holds a teaching degree from Western Michigan College where he majored in physical education. He's somewhat conscious of his large size which handicaps him most when he's away from his 7-foot bed at home.

"But you get used to it," said Ron. "My feet hang over a little in other beds but I've become accustomed to sleeping that way."

ANOTHER hurler has been added to the Indianapolis pitching platoon with the optioning of Bill Dufour, a right-hander, by the Chicago White Sox. Dufour will not report here until Sunday, having received permission to go to his home in Memphis, Tenn., where his wife recently had a baby.

Dufour, of French descent, was a 10-10 hurler at Memphis last season, but ranked third in the Southern Association in earned-run average with a mark of 3.21. Bill is reputed to have lots of stuff, but Manager Andy Cohen says "he's inclined to be erratic and wild."

First indication of the Tribe's opening-day pitcher against Minneapolis April 16 came yesterday when Manager Cohen said: "He's going as far as he can to get ready for the grand opening."

The reference was to Al Papai (pronounced Poppy) who worked an easy seven innings against the Sky Sox.

"Just look at him," exclaimed Cohen later. "The way he's throwing he'll still be pitching when he's 60 years old. Just like playing 'catch' out there."



BILL DUFOUR
Brings 3.21 ERA

Papai uses little motion in his delivery and at times yesterday he was serving without a windup. Nine of 10 pitches were knucklers and Sam Hairston had a busy—and good—afternoon chasing the butterflies.

Catcher John Romano has been sidelined by soreness in his shoulder and elbow.

"This spring is the first time the arm ever bothered me," said Romano, who explains his nickname of Honey was tagged on him when he was a youngster, probably because he is the youngest of six children.

Romano is taking treatments for what doctors believe to be calcium deposits. He has been ordered not to throw for several days. A more complete diagnosis of Romano's ailment was expected after X-rays were taken today.

MANAGER Cohen had a red face last night and it wasn't from the intense sun. His body must have been sore, too, from the "needles" injected by Ownie Bush, Tribe president.

In the fifth inning of yesterday's game, Hairston batted out of turn in front of Charlie Williams, who never did come to the plate in that inning. Neither Cohen, nor the "officials" directing the Colorado Springs club were aware of the rule violation until reminded by "bench" players when the inning was over.

"You know," drawled Williams, "I sat there on that chair and just let Sam walk up there and take my turn at bat. I don't know what to tell you. It must be this sun."

COLLEGE TRACK

Northwestern Louisiana 91, McNeese 30½,
Southwestern Louisiana 36½